

A conference on information security

Come February 15th, Goa will play host to the winter edition of *nullcon*—a 4-day conference organised by *null*, a security community in India with more than 2000 members comprising information security professionals, ethical hackers and law enforcement professionals. *null* focuses on infosec research, and in assisting government and private organisations with cyber security issues.

The talks at the conference will range from Web hacking, security and hacking tools, phone hacking and cyber warfare, to zero day vulnerabilities.

"We see that currently there is a disconnect between the government agencies and private organisations when it comes to cyber security and we aim to fill the gap in a vendor-neutral way," says Pratul Bajaj, operations head, *null*.

null currently runs many projects to help organisations tighten their security infrastructure, including the Keeda Project, which is aimed at mitigating the threats caused by a database of vulnerabilities found in the wild. Its other well-known initiatives include *nullcon* (www.nullcon.net), an international security conference, and training programmes.

null has seven chapters in India at Pune, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Hyderabad, Delhi, Chennai and Bhopal. These are run entirely by volunteers, who interact with around 5000-6000 people by engaging them in various activities such as monthly meets, security camps, workshops, talks by security experts at various events, and by running security projects.

For more information on security research, responsible vulnerability disclosure, open source security software, white papers, presentations, et al, refer to <http://null.co.in>

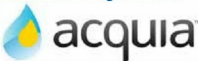


standardising hardware extensions to Android devices, exploring 3D gesture-based User Interfaces, creating a context-aware framework for Android, developing multi-purpose applications on the platform, and providing policy recommendations for open hardware architecture in view of the rapid obsolescence of these devices. Four out of the six approved project components will be implemented at Technopark, Trivandrum. The other two are to be implemented by CDAC (Centre for Development of Advanced Computing) Delhi and CDAC Chennai.

Acquia promotes use of free website-building software

Acquia, the 'enterprise guide to Drupal', has disclosed plans to expand its presence in India in order to promote the use of the free software,

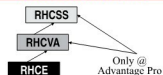
Drupal. Ronald C Pruett, Jr, chief marketing officer, Acquia, said, "We have two training partners in India, whose operations we are planning to scale up massively. In this visit, we are doing a need analysis of the Indian market, and soon we will announce initiatives specific to India... Drupal will help companies build their websites without having to pay for the software."



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